Peer response

Hi Abinel,

I enjoyed reading your discussion because it provides a balanced view of how digital technologies can both support and challenge human rights investigations. I agree that tools such as AI, satellite imagery and OSINT have made it easier to collect evidence, especially in areas that are difficult to access. However, as you pointed out, these technologies are only as reliable as the data they use. When data are incomplete or biased, they can lead to unfair decisions and overlook the experiences of vulnerable communities Hancock et al.'s (2024a).

I also agree with your point about involving local communities in the design of these technologies. People who are directly affected by human rights issues often have valuable knowledge that can improve the accuracy and usefulness of digital tools. Including them in the design process can build trust and ensure that technology is used to support, rather than replace, human judgement. UNESCO (2021) also highlights the importance of transparency, fairness and stakeholder participation in the ethical use of AI.

Overall, your post reminds us that technology should be viewed as a tool to assist investigators, not as a complete solution. Combining innovation with community involvement and ethical governance is essential to protecting human rights effectively.

References

Hancock, J., Hui, R., Mazumder, A. and Singh, J. (2024) 'Seeing Human Rights at Sea: How to Align Tech Development with the Needs of Maritime Human Rights Investigators and Affected Communities', Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems. Available at: https://doi.org/10.1145/3613905.3651081

Hancock, J., Hui, R., Singh, J. and Mazumder, A. (2024) Trouble at Sea: Data and Digital Technology Challenges for Maritime Human Rights Concerns. In: Proceedings of the 2024 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (FAccT '24).

UNESCO (2021) Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence. Available at: https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000381137 (Accessed: 2 August 2026).